

Curriculum for BI3016 Molecular cell biology autumn 2026

Textbook: Molecular biology of the cell, 7th edition, Alberts et al. (2022)

Lecture 1

Chapter 7: Control of Gene Expression

Part 1: An overview of gene control (pages 397-410)
Transcription regulators switch genes on and off (410-423)
The molecular mechanism that create specialized cell types (423-435)

Lecture 2

Chapter 7: Control of Gene Expression

Part 2: Mechanisms that reinforce cell memory in plants and animals (435-445).
Post transcriptional controls (445-462).
Regulation of gene expression by non-coding RNAs (462-471).

Lecture 3.

Chapter 15: Cell Signalling

Part 1: Principles of cell signalling (873-892).

Lecture 4.

Chapter 15: Cell Signalling

Part 2: Signalling through G-protein-coupled receptors (892-910).

Lecture 5.

Chapter 15: Cell Signalling

Part 3: Signalling through enzyme-coupled cell surface receptors (911-927).
Alternative signalling routes in gene regulation (928-940)

Lecture 6.

Chapter 15: Plant signalling mechanisms

Signalling in plants (940-945) Alberts et al. 2022
Articles:
Will be published later

Lecture 7.

Chapter 16: The Cytoskeleton

Actin (957-975).
Myosin and actin (976-986).
Microtubules (987-1007).
Cell polarity and coordination of the cytoskeleton (1016-1023)

Lecture 8.

Chapter 17: The Cell Cycle

Overview of the cell cycle (1027-1031)
The cell-cycle control system (1031-1042)
S-phase and Mitosis (1042-1064)

Cytokinesis (1064-1070)
Control of cell division and cell growth (1077-1084)

Lecture 9.

Chapter 18: Cell death

Apoptosis (1089-1102)
Leading edge review article:
Cell death: Newton K. et al. Cell 187, January 18, 2024 (pages 235-248).

Lecture 10

Chapter 19: Cells in their social context: Cell junctions and the extracellular matrix

Cell-cell junctions (1105-1127)
The extracellular matrix of animals (1141-1146)
Cell-matrix junctions (1147-1154)

Lecture 11.

Chapter 20: Cancer

Cancer as a microevolutionary process (1163-1178)
Cancer-critical genes: How they are found and what they do (1178-1198)
Cancer prevention and treatment: present and future (1198-1213)

Lecture 12.

Chapter 21: Development of multicellular organisms

Overview of development (1217-1226)
Mechanisms of pattern formation (1226-1248)